Product and Problem Overview

NextStep's Goal

To design and validate a decision-first, personalised product that helps early professionals discover, commit to, and act on their next learning goal — without feeling overwhelmed, distracted, or stuck in endless research.

The Problem Space

Mission: To help early professionals learn with clarity and momentum through personalized skill recommendations and immediate action challenges.
Assumption: We have full creative flexibility. We are solving for mobile-first, career-driven professionals with limited attention and emotional energy.

What is Learning Confidence?

The ability to choose the right skill, commit, and achieve a quick win without doubt or drop-off.

Market Space (Global) To view the research, click here

$320B E-learning industry source 1

168M+ Global registered learners source 2

~9% CAGR Growth rate source 3

Problems Faced by Users

"I spend more time picking a course than actually learning it."

- **Silent Paralysis:** Users want to upskill but stall at the decision stage.
- **Scattered Growth:** Many start multiple courses but drop off with no progress.
- **Fear of Wasting Time/Money**: Overthinking → hesitation or irrelevant skills.

Why a Learning Confidence Product?

⚡ **73% stall at the start** → trapped in research.
🎯 **61% doubt their choice** → unsure if skill is right.
⛔ **85% drop mid-course** → intent ≠ progress.

NextStep
Learn what's next

Decide. Start. Win.

Validating the Problem

Who are the customers facing this problem? *Hypothesis*

Early professionals and advanced students (19–29) in tech, product, design, and marketing — ambitious, but overwhelmed by too many choices, unsure of relevance, and anxious about wasting time or money.

Aryan
23
Gurugram

"I jump in excited, but then I lose track or see another tool trending."

Needs
Guidance to validate whether a chosen skill is worth pursuing.

Pain Points
Constantly distracted by new tools, feels unsure if time is well spent.

Secondary Research *(Competitor Research)*

LinkedIn Workplace Learning Report 2024: 90% of professionals want to upskill, but only a fraction sustain it.

Nasscom & Deloitte 2024: Gen Z and early professionals in India are most eager to learn, yet most likely to feel overwhelmed by choice and uncertain skill relevance.

Insights from Users

73% delay picking a skill due to overthinking and fear of choosing wrong.

61% doubt whether the chosen skill truly aligns with career goals.

57% explicitly asked for direct, personalized recommendations.

Survey link *Responses* *User Interviews*

What is the true problem?

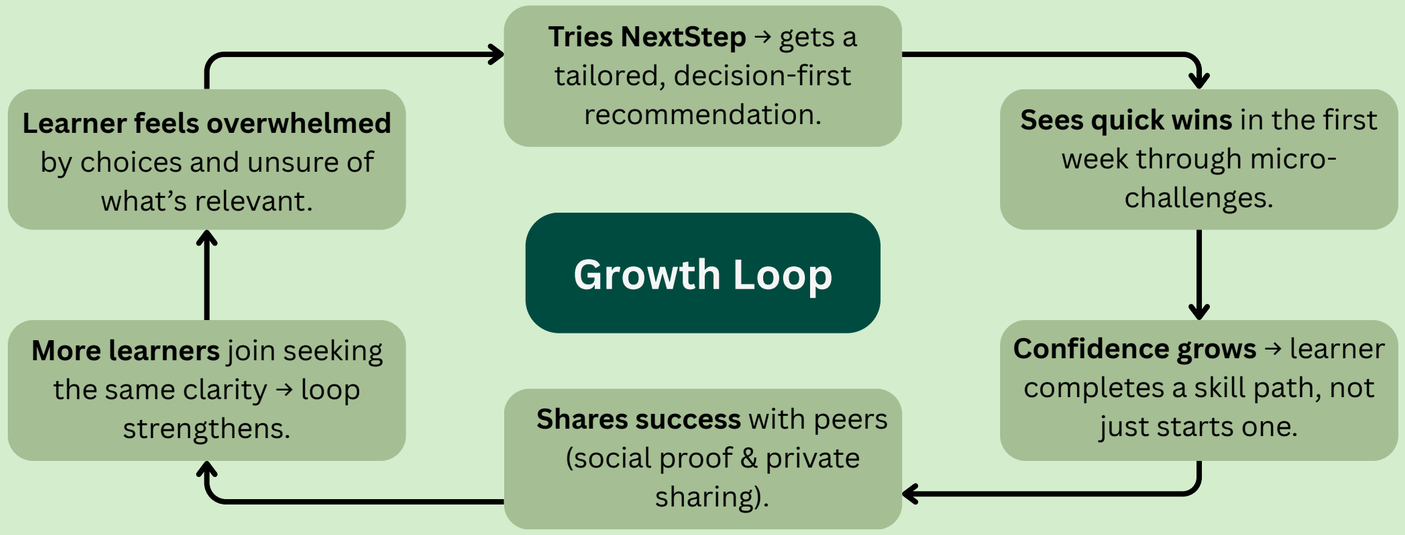
Stuck at Start → 73% delay picking a skill, unsure what's relevant.
"I spend more time deciding than learning."

Low Confidence in Choice → 61% feel unsure if the skill aligns with career goals.
"Many drop off when relevance isn't obvious."

ROI Anxiety → Many feared wasting time/money on "random" or "hype" skills

Value generated by solving this problem

Significance:



Value Generated:

For Users

- **Clarity over Chaos** → One relevant next step, not endless tabs.
- **Action over Delay** → Small wins turn hesitation into momentum.
- **Confidence over Doubt** → Visible progress proves ROI early.

"A user who once felt stuck now sees learning as progress, not paralysis."

For Business

- **Stickiness** → Faster wins mean lower drop-offs.
- **Differentiation** → Not a library, but the decision engine.
- **Organic Growth** → Success stories fuel peer adoption.

"A business that's not just selling courses, but building the "confidence engine" for modern learners."

Why should we solve this now? *Survey Responses*

- **High Intent, Low Action** → 85% of Indian professionals plan to upskill, but 73% of our users delay choosing a skill due to overwhelm. *source 1*, *source 2*
- **Midway Collapse** → MOOCs average 5–15% completion. Similarly, 68% of surveyed learners drop off mid-course, citing "lost motivation" or "found something else." *source*
- **Choice Paralysis** → Overchoice is a proven barrier. Our users echoed: "I spend more time deciding than learning."*source*
- **Tools Don't Solve It** → MOOCs = overwhelming catalogs, Microlearning apps = gamified but not career-linked → Neither provides clarity or ROI confidence. *(Competitor Research)*

Ideating Potential Solutions

Skill Goal Finder Quiz

"What should I learn next?" answered in 3 minutes.

Overview → A short, career-aligned quiz that cuts through noise and points users to one skill that actually matters.

Why it matters → Solves decision paralysis. Instead of wandering across platforms, users get clarity and confidence instantly.

First Win Challenge

"Your first step, not your first course."

Overview → Learners get a 2-day micro-project tied to their chosen skill (like designing a mock screen, writing a blog snippet, or automating a sheet).

Why it matters → Fights the midway collapse. By giving an early "I did it" moment, it creates visible progress and stickiness.

AI Mentor Nudges

"A gentle push, when you need it most."

Overview → AI-powered, lightweight check-ins that nudge learners with encouragement, relevance ("why this skill matters for your career"), and reminders.

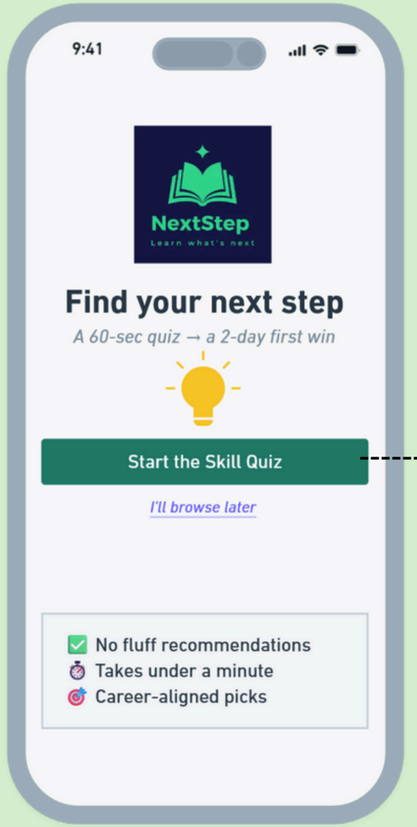
Why it matters → Tackles motivation dips and ROI anxiety. Keeps the journey alive without overwhelming.

Prioritization

A structured RICE-based prioritization was conducted—click to explore details.

Solution	Reach (R)	Impact (I)	Confidence (C%)	Effort (E)	RICE Score	Verdict
Skill Goal Finder Quiz (Clarity First)	9	3	80%	1 *(super light effort: <2 min quiz)*	(9 × 3 × 0.8) / 1 = **21.6**	★ Highest
First-Win Challenge	7	2	75%	2	(7 × 2 × 0.75) / 2 = **5.25**	◆ Moderate
AI Mentor Nudges	5	2	60%	3	(5 × 2 × 0.6) / 3 = **2.0**	▪ Lowest

Bringing the Solution to Life (Primary Solution)

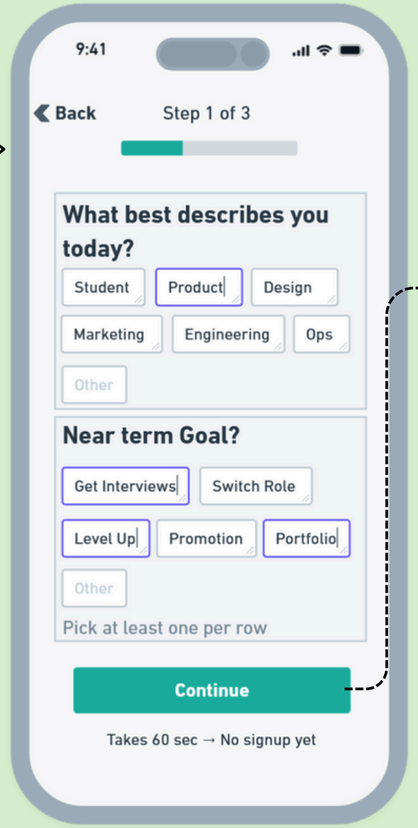


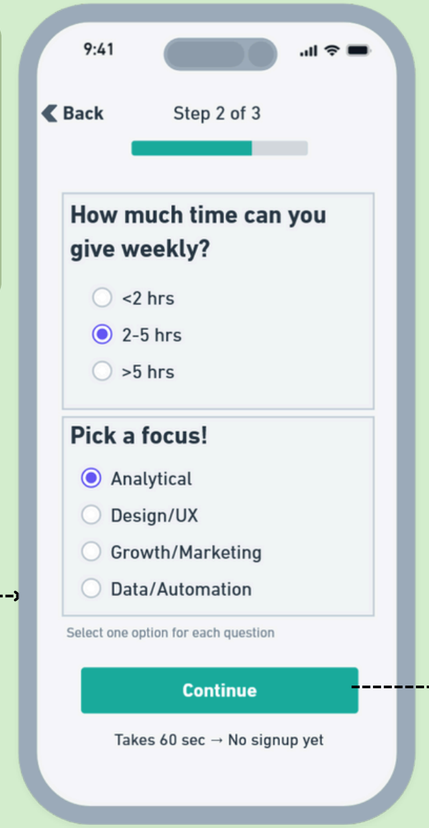
Welcome

One bold action: "Find your next step." Cuts through the overwhelm 73% of learners face.

Role & Goal

Learners state who they are + what they want. No more generic plans, only career-aligned starts.



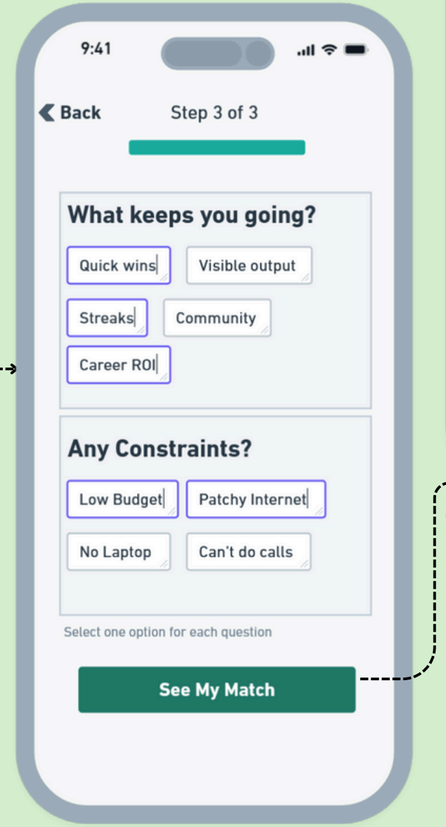


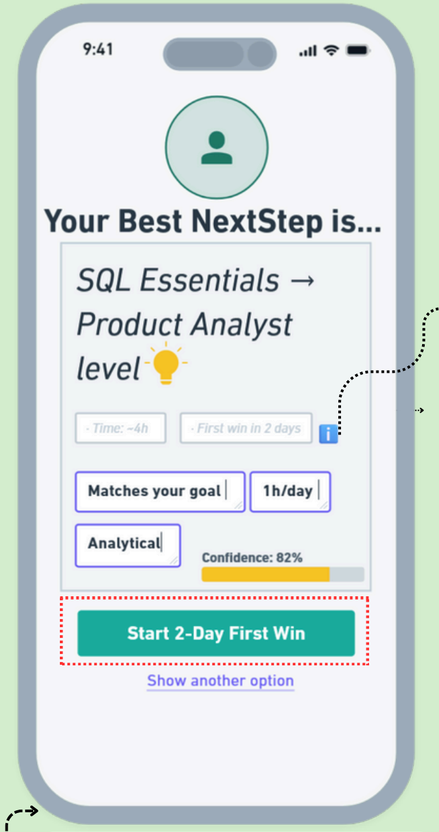
Time & Focus

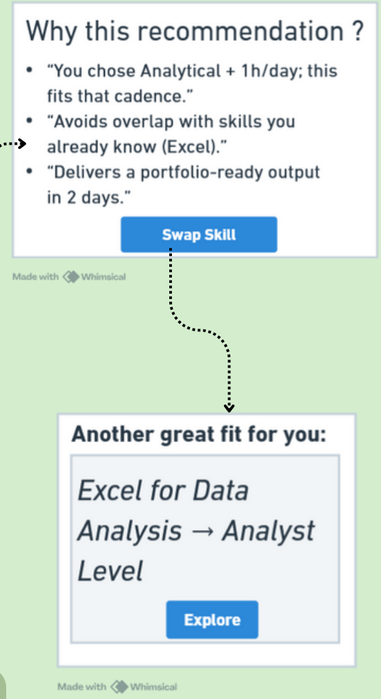
Sets a pace that feels doable. Learners choose hours + focus so learning feels realistic, not impossible.

Motivation & Constraints

Builds around what drives you (ROI, streaks) and respects limits (budget, devices). Keeps drop-offs low.







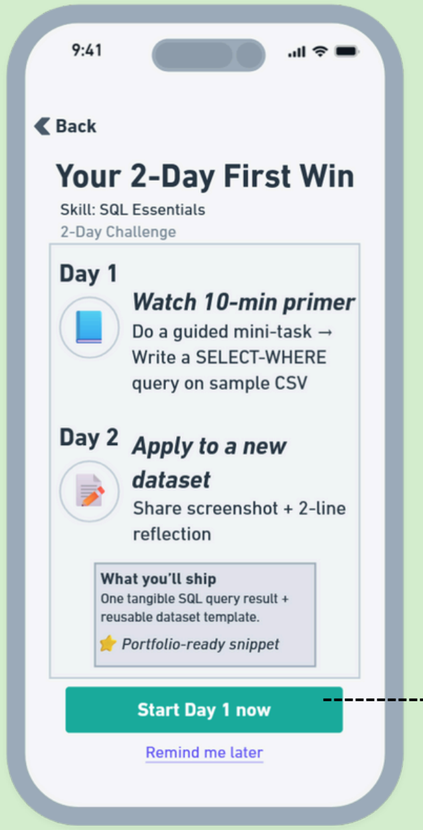
Skill Match

No endless lists—just one clear skill card with "Why this" logic. Confidence replaces doubt.

Link to wireframes

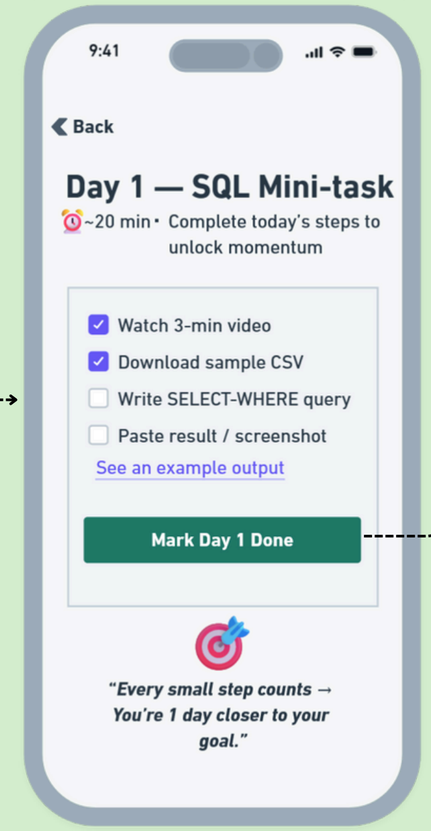
Wireframing

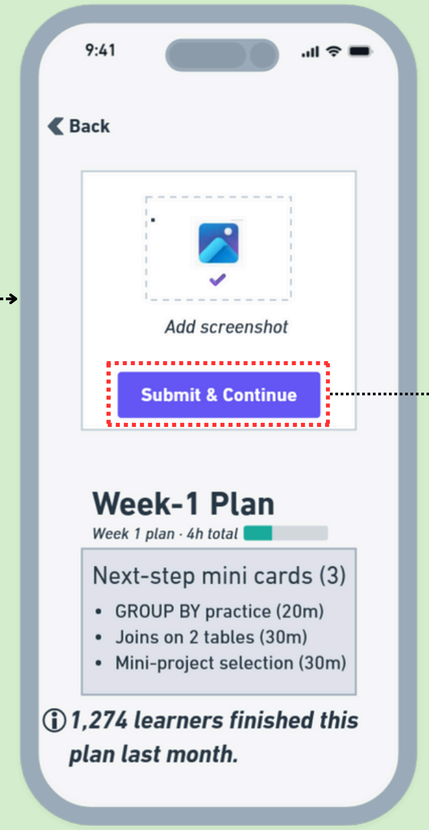
Bringing the Solution to Life (Extension Solution)



First-Win Overview
A 2-day micro-project → tangible output. Learners ship, not just watch. Motivation by design.

Active Challenge
Checklist-driven tasks = visible progress. Learners never feel lost, only "done."





Submit & Week-1 Plan
Share your first win → celebrate streaks → unlock a simple week plan. Momentum secured.

*Once learners find the right skill (Screens 1–5), the biggest risk is they stall again. So, **we layered a 2-day First Win Challenge** (Screens 6–8) to convert **clarity into momentum**.*

Questions you'd ask your friend, answered by NextStep.
FAQ — Read here

Link to wireframes

Wireframing

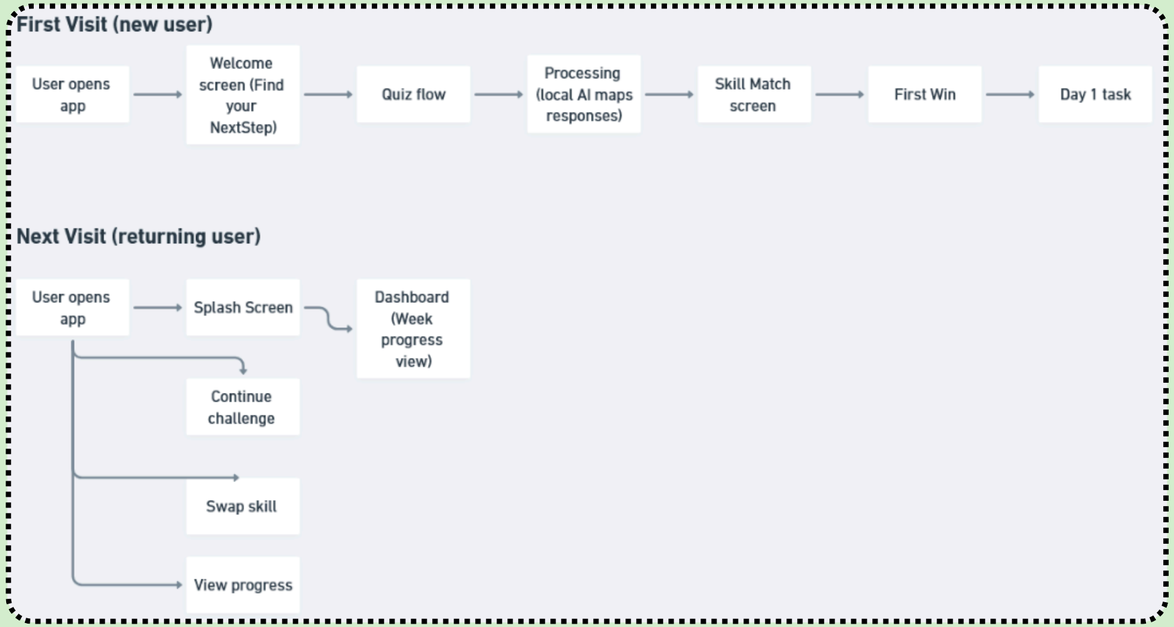
How we'll Scale...

Monetisation Plan

NextStep skips ads and freemium models—**the focus stays on learning.**

- **7-day free trial** → quiz, skill match & first challenge
- **Monthly ₹79** → full paths & tracking
- **Yearly ₹749** → mentor nudges + premium content
- **Partnerships** → bulk licensing for colleges/EdTech
- **Add-ons** → paid skill micro-certificates

Data Flow Diagram



Core User Journey

user flow, app flow, *System overview*

Stage	Goal	User Actions	Touch Points
✨ **Awareness**	Discover a better way to upskill	Learner sees LinkedIn post / friend referral highlighting "60-sec quiz → 2-day win"	LinkedIn posts, Referrals, Student Communities
🚀 **Onboarding**	Understand the app & take first step	• Downloads the app • Sees "Find your next step" CTA • Starts quick Skill Quiz	Welcome screen, Skill Quiz intro
🔍 **Exploration**	Identify career-aligned skills fast	• Completes 3-step quiz (role, time, motivation) • Gets curated skill match with "Why this" explanation	Quiz screens, Skill Match card, Alt swap option
🏆 **Engagement**	Build momentum with a micro-win	• Accepts 2-day First Win Challenge • Completes Day 1 checklist • Uploads reflection on Day 2	Challenge overview, Daily task tracker, Submit panel
🔄 **Retention**	Stay consistent in learning journey	• Unlocks Week-1 plan • Tracks small wins • Shares progress streak • Option to swap skills later	Week-1 Progress tracker, Streak nudges, Swap option

Business Model

How we'll measure the success

North Star Metric:

First-Win Completion Rate *(Why?)*

(% of new users who complete their first 2-day skill challenge within the first week)

Is it easy to find the app and reach first skill match?

Do users start challenges and return to track progress?

Do learners stay over time and recommend NextStep?

Type	Metric	Goal
Acquisition	📊 New app installs/week 📊 Source of installs (referrals, LinkedIn, organic, campus, etc.)	Track discovery channels & adoption reach.
Activation	📊 % Users completing Skill Quiz 📊 Avg. time to first skill match	Show how quickly users go from "curious" → "matched skill."
Adoption	📊 % Users starting a First-Win Challenge 📊 Avg. # of First-Wins completed in Month 1	Indicate early habit-building and trust.
Engagement	📊 Avg. daily/weekly session length 📊 % Users exploring alternate skill paths (Swap Skill)	Measure curiosity & active exploration.
Retention	📊 % Returning users after 30 days 📊 % Continuing to second skill challenge	Check ongoing value & commitment to learning path.
Satisfaction	📊 First-Win Satisfaction Score (post-challenge prompt) 📊 Net Skill Recommendation (NPS: "Would you recommend this skill path?")	Capture emotional fulfillment + likelihood of endorsement.

Fueling Growth, Fighting Friction

Distribution Model

- ***College Partnerships*** – Partner with universities to integrate NextStep into student employability and skill-building programs.
- ***Referrals & Viral Loops*** – Reward learners for inviting peers to try quizzes and challenges.
- ***Social Media Play*** – Use skill-growth storytelling reels, micro-wins, and "challenge streaks" on Instagram/LinkedIn.
- ***EdTech/Corporate Tie-ups*** – Bundle NextStep with job-prep and upskilling platforms.
- ***Content & Community*** – Share learner journeys, quick tips, and first-win stories to spark organic buzz.
- ***App Store Optimization*** – Highlight *"no ads, privacy-first, skill-first"* in keywords & reviews.

Activation Strategy

- ***Start Fast, Win Early*** – Within 3 days, nudge learners to finish their first skill challenge with quick scheduling.
- ***Micro-Streak Momentum*** – Gamify the 7-day trial with daily nudges like "swap a skill," "check progress," or "unlock Day 2 tip."
- ***Celebrate & Continue*** – By Day 7, show learner progress (1 quiz, 1 win, 1 new skill explored) and invite them to unlock more paths.

Risks and Mitigations

Drop-off After Trial

- ***Risk:*** *Learners enjoy trial but don't convert.*
- ***Mitigation****: Show visible progress streaks, emotional value ("you unlocked your first win"), and offer flexible student pricing.*

Low Challenge Participation

- ***Risk:*** *Users hesitate to start the first skill challenge due to fear of failure.*
- ***Mitigation:*** *Use small, low-pressure Day 1 challenges and explain "why this skill matters."*

Progress Fatigue

- ***Risk:*** *Learners may lose momentum after early wins.*
- ***Mitigation:*** *Add swap-skill option, lightweight dashboard, and streak nudges to keep engagement high.*

Thank you